"IN THE BEGINNING..."

# GENESIS 35

## IN 5 MINUTES

### When:

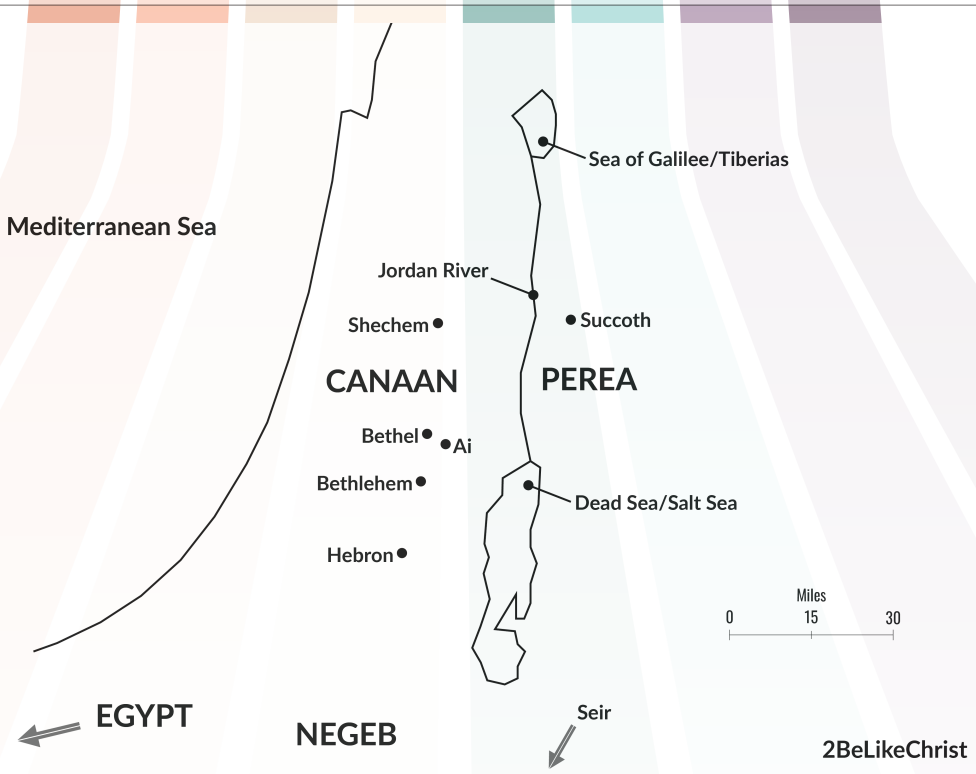
- There isn't enough information in the text to date the events of this chapter with precision.
- Most of the events of Genesis 35 took place after Jacob's return to Canaan, sometime between 1745-1725 B.C.
- Isaac died in approximately 1716 B.C.

### Characters:

- **Jacob** – The son of Isaac and Rebekah and twin brother of Esau. He had recently returned from Haran to dwell in Canaan. God renamed him Israel.
- **Rachel** – Jacob's favorite wife and the mother of Joseph and Benjamin.
- **Isaac** – The son of Abraham and father of Jacob.

### Where:

- Jacob travelled to Bethel and built an altar where he had seen a vision more than 20 years earlier.
- Rachel died on the way to Ephrath, also known as Bethlehem.
- Isaac lived in Mamre (also known as Kiriath-arba or Hebron).

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## Outline:

- JACOB RETURNS TO BETHEL (35:1-15):
    + God told Jacob to return to Bethel, where he had seen the vision of the heavenly ladder (Gen 28), and build an altar there.
    + Jacob told his household to get rid of all their foreign Gods.
    + Jacob took their idols and buried them under a tree near Shechem.
    + God caused a great terror to fall on the people of the land so they would not pursue Jacob's family to avenge Hamor and Shechem (Gen 34).
    + Jacob built an altar in Bethel to honor the Lord who watched over him when he fled from Esau.
    + God appeared to Jacob and told him his name would be changed to Israel.
    + He told Jacob He would make him the father of nations and would give him the land of Canaan.
    + Jacob set up a pillar of stone in the place God appeared to him.
- THE DEATH OF RACHEL (35:16-21):
    + Rachel went into labor as their family was travelling to Ephrath (Bethlehem).
    + She had "hard labor" and died shortly after delivering a son.
    + Jacob named the boy Benjamin.
- JACOB'S 12 SONS (35:22-26):
    + Jacob had children with 4 women: Leah, Rachel, Bilhah, and Zilpah.
    + Jacob's 12 sons: Reuben, Simeon, Levi, Judah, Issachar, Zebulun, Joseph, Benjamin, Dan, Naphtali, Gad, and Asher.
- THE DEATH OF ISAAC (35:27-29):
    + Jacob visited his father Isaac at Mamre (Hebron).
    + Isaac died at 180 years old and was buried by Jacob and Esau.

## Application:

- God was with us before we found the people we would love the most, and He will be with us when we lose the people we've loved the most.
- God was with Jacob before he went to Haran and found the woman he loved (Rachel), and He was with Jacob when she left him on the road outside Bethlehem.
- What a friend we have in Jesus.